How Clear Is the Family's Picture of What Matters in This Decision?

Twelve quick questions about what the family knows. At the end: what you know, what's still unclear, and what to ask.

Answer yes, no or not sure. This checks how much has been asked and written down. It doesn't measure your loved one or your family, and nothing here says who is right or what to choose.

1. Can you say in one plain sentence what decision the family has to make?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

2. Has your loved one been asked, recently, what they want in this decision?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

3. Is what they said written down in their own words, not in a relative's summary?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

4. Do you know which routines and everyday choices they most want to keep?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

5. On paper, are your loved one's wishes kept apart from what the family wants for them?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

6. Has every relative involved been asked what worries them and what they hope for, including the ones who say little?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

7. Do you know what each relative can and cannot realistically do?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

8. Have you written down where the family already agrees?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

9. Have you written down where the family doesn't agree, in words each person would call fair?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

10. Have you listed the questions that need a doctor, a nurse or another professional?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

11. Does each open question have the name of the person who will get it answered?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

12. Has the family talked yet about what the choice will be measured against, before comparing options?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

Answer the questions above and your page builds here.

WHAT YOU KNOW

WHAT'S STILL UNCLEAR

QUESTIONS TO CLARIFY

What this doesn't do

It counts what has been asked and written down, not how your loved one is doing or how well the family gets along. A low count means there are conversations still to have, and most of them start with one question to one person.

Ready for the next step?

You can see what the family knows and what's still open. Keep the page you just copied beside you: the care interview goes through your loved one's situation area by area, so what matters to them sits next to a full account of what the decision is about, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›